



X11 Forwarding in SSH: connection rejected because of wrong authentication

Question & Answer

Question

Why is the "connection rejected because of wrong authentication" in X11 Forwarding through SSH?

Cause

The issue occurs because they have changed the userid to root with "su -".

The root user does not have a DISPLAY set, nor will root have credentials for the original user DISPLAY.

Answer

TARGET AUDIENCE:

Users of SSH X11 Forwarding who su - to become root

OBJECTIVE:

Provide an explanation of errors and work around

PROCEDURES:

The following instructions explain typical scenarios and provide resolution steps.

PROBLEM RE-CREATION STEPS:

1) Enable X11 forwarding on AIX

```
% cp /etc/ssh/sshd_config /etc/ssh/sshd_config.save
% vi /etc/ssh/sshd_config
```



About cookies on this site

Our websites require some cookies to function properly (required). In addition, other cookies may be used with your consent to analyze site usage, improve the user experience and for advertising.

For more information, please review your [cookie preferences](#) options. By visiting our website, you agree to our processing of information as described in IBM's [privacy statement](#)

(<https://www.ibm.com/privacy>)

To provide a smooth navigation, your cookie preferences will be shared across the IBM web domains listed [here](#).

Accept all

Required only

2) Connect to the AIX Server from a remote PC, or other Linux/Unix system with an Xserver running. (This

can be through PUTTY, or various Xemuators which connect through ssh)

The basic underlying command is

```
% ssh -X NON_ROOT_USER@hostname
```

NOTE: *NON_ROOT_USER* is the non-root-userid

If the X11 forwarding is successful, the DISPLAY will be set

```
% echo $DISPLAY
localhost:10
```

NOTE: The default DISPLAY number is 10 (**See/etc/ssh/sshd_config #X11DisplayOffset 10**) but this number may be different if multiple connections are established.

3) Now become root

```
% sudo su -
```

4) Check root's DISPLAY

```
% echo $DISPLAY
(null)
```

NOTE: This is expected. This is not the same userid which connected to, and established credentials for localhost:10.

5) Now, export the DISPLAY to the previously established secure X11 forwarding session

```
% export DISPLAY=localhost:10
```

6) Check connection access

```
% xhost
```

Typical Error: "X11 connection rejected because of wrong authentication "

NOTE: This is expected. The xauth credentials for this DISPLAY were established for \$NON_ROOT_USER and must be shared with root.

PROBLEM RESOLUTION STEPS:



About cookies on this site

Our websites require some cookies to function properly (required). In addition, other cookies may be used with your consent to analyze site usage, improve the user experience and for advertising.

For more information, please review your [cookie preferences](#) options. By visiting our website, you agree to our processing of information as described in IBM's [privacy statement](#)

(<https://www.ibm.com/privac>
y)

To provide a smooth navigation, your cookie preferences will be shared across the IBM web domains listed [here](#).

Accept all

Required only

8) Check connection access .

```
% xhost
```

NOTE: This message will vary based on the Xserver access controls

```
% xauth remove localhost:10
```

Developer Works "Remote X11 Windows to AIX"

(<https://www.ibm.com/developerworks/community/blogs/paixperiences/entry/remotex11aix?lang=en>)

WWMISC

If additional assistance is required after completing all of the instructions provided in this document, please follow the step-by-step instructions below to contact IBM to open a service request (PMR) for software under warranty or with an active and valid support contract. The technical support specialist assigned to your support call will confirm that you have completed these steps.

- a. Document and/or take screen shots of all symptoms, errors, and/or messages that might have occurred
- b. Capture any logs or data relevant to the situation
- c. Contact IBM to open a support call (PMR):

For electronic support, please visit the web page:

Our websites require some cookies to function properly (required). In addition, other cookies may be used with your consent to analyze site usage, improve the user experience and for advertising.

For more information, please review your [cookie preferences](#) options. By visiting our website, you agree to our processing of information as described in IBM's [privacy statement](#)

(<https://www.ibm.com/privac>
y)

To provide a smooth navigation, your cookie preferences will be shared across the IBM web domains listed [here](#).

Accept all

Required only

e. Upload all of the details and data to your support call (PMR):

Please visit this web page for instructions: <https://www.secure.ecurep.ibm.com/app/upload>
(<https://www.secure.ecurep.ibm.com/app/upload>)

FEEDBACK:

Quality documentation is important to IBM and its customers. If you have feedback specific to this article, please send an detailed message to the email address:

aix_feedback@wwpdl.vnet.ibm.com (mailto:aix_feedback@wwpdl.vnet.ibm.com)

- This email address is monitored for feedback purposes only.
- No support for any IBM products or services will be provided through this email.
- To receive support, please follow the step-by-step instructions in the above "SUPPORT" section.

Document Information

More support for:

[AIX](https://www.ibm.com/mysupport/s/topic/OTO5000000QRu1GAG) (<https://www.ibm.com/mysupport/s/topic/OTO5000000QRu1GAG>)

Software version:

Version Independent

Operating system(s):

AIX

Document number:

632813

Modified date:

15 September 2021

About cookies on this site

Our websites require some cookies to function properly (required). In addition, other cookies may be used with your consent to analyze site usage, improve the user experience and for advertising.

For more information, please review your [cookie preferences](#) options. By visiting our website, you agree to our processing of information as described in IBM's [privacy statement](#)

(<https://www.ibm.com/privacy>)

To provide a smooth navigation, your cookie preferences will be shared across the IBM web domains listed [here](#).

Accept all

Required only